

Art & Design

Year 4

Student Manual



Art & Design

Year 4 · Student Manual

The Wall Studio

A student book for Lower Primary, written for pupils of about eight to nine years old. It teaches four kinds of making and one habit that runs through all of them: look closely, decide what the work is for, and then make it well.

Four tables in one studio: printing, painting, drawing with perspective and building in three dimensions. Rufus the fox plans every print before the stamp goes down; Bruno the bear mixes colour slowly and paints the big shapes first. Work beside them through twenty topics and finish by curating the Studio show.

Art & Design · Year 4

Student Manual. First edition, 2026.

Prime Books is the publishing imprint of Prime School, Portugal.

www.primeschool.pt

© Prime School 2026. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means without the prior written permission of the publisher.

Independent publication. This book was written and produced by Prime School International for use within its own programmes of study. It is not affiliated with, licensed by or endorsed by any examination board or awarding body. References to curriculum frameworks represent the interpretation of the authors.

Trademark acknowledgements. All product names, trademarks and registered trademarks named in this book are the property of their respective owners and are used for identification and educational comment only. No endorsement is implied and none should be inferred.

Editorial Board. Pedagogical Academic Group · Pedagogical Team · Pedagogical Department · Content Creation Team.

Text, design and illustration. Written and designed by the Prime Books editorial studio. Original watercolour illustration produced for Prime School. All illustrations © Prime School 2026.

Illustration note. The illustrations in this book were created with the assistance of generative artificial intelligence as part of the creative production process. All text was written, edited and checked by our subject authors and teachers.

Safety. The activities in this book are written for pupils aged eight to nine working with a teacher nearby. Cutting, and any clay or tool work, needs an adult. Teachers follow their own risk assessment and school safety policy.

Interior 8.5 × 11 in. British English throughout. Printed in Portugal on paper from responsibly managed forests.

Contents

Welcome to the Wall Studio	04
Who you will meet	06
How to use this book	06
Getting set up	08
Unit 1 Printing for a purpose	10
1.1 Exploring printing techniques	12
1.2 Using colour in printing	16
1.3 Designing for a purpose	19
1.4 Producing a final print	22
Unit 2 Approaches to painting	29
2.1 Experimenting with brush techniques	31
2.2 Mixing and using colour	34
2.3 Exploring textures in painting	37
2.4 Working from observation	39
Unit 3 Drawing with perspective	46
3.1 One- and two-point perspective	48
3.2 Drawing dynamic figures	51

3.3 Line, tone and shading for depth	55
3.4 Perspective and movement together	57
Unit 4 Architecture in 3D	63
4.1 Studying architectural forms	65
4.2 Constructing simple 3D models	68
4.3 Materials and textures	72
4.4 A 3D architectural project	74
Studio show	75
Studio words	80
Answers	80
Sources and references	81
For teachers	81

Welcome to the Wall Studio

There is a long table indoors. There is also a wall outdoors that wants a picture.

This book is both places. It is called **the Wall Studio**, and it belongs to you for this Year 4.

Last year you looked carefully, built mosaics, painted from life and made simple structures. Keep that. This year you print with a reason, paint with more control, draw so space feels deep, and build a small piece of architecture you can hold.

Four kinds of making live here:

- 1 **Printing** for a clear purpose
- 2 **Painting** with brushes, colour and texture
- 3 **Drawing** with perspective and movement
- 4 **Architecture** built in three dimensions

Rufus the fox plans carefully before the stamp goes down. Bruno the bear mixes colour slowly and is happy to start a wall again if the first layer needs it.

🕒 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Year 3 you drew from encounter, made mosaics, painted and built structure. This year the craft words get sharper: purpose, perspective, architecture. Your hands still lead. Your eyes still check.

Who you will meet



Rufus the fox

He plans a print before he presses. He likes clean edges, honest colour and buildings that stand. When a model wobbles, he redesigns the join.



Bruno the bear

He paints big first, then adds texture. He rolls colour onto a wall as if he has all afternoon. He is good at saying what a design is for.



The long table

Print blocks dry here. Paint pots rest here. Plans for buildings start as pencil boxes on this table.

You

Age about eight or nine. Ready to design with purpose, check your work, and try again without giving up.

How to use this book

The same friendly signs come back on every page. Learn them once.

✦ SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- **Open the door** - a question to talk about before you begin
- **Warm up your hands** - a quick game so your hands wake up
- **Look and learn** - something new, with a picture that shows how
- **Your turn** - time to make, print, paint, draw or build
- **Did you know?** - a true and surprising fact
- **Go a bit further** - an extra idea if you finish
- **Big challenge** - a harder task; take your time
- **How did it go?** - a short look back at your work

When you see a **dashed box**, that space is yours. Draw in it. Stick in it. There are no printed right answers for open making.



Picture 0.1 The same signs return on every page, so you always know what to do next.

Getting set up

Your studio kit

You will not need everything at once. Each unit tells you what to fetch.

- pencils (hard and soft), rubber, sharpener
- printing materials: foam block or potato, tray, roller or sponge, washable ink
- washable paints, flat and round brushes, water pot, rags
- charcoal or soft graphite for tone
- card, corrugated cardboard, tape, string, small boxes for architecture
- clay or air-dry clay (adult choice), safety scissors, glue
- apron or old shirt
- a sketchbook or spare paper that can take a print

Room norms

- 1 Look with your eyes before you touch with your hands.
- 2 Share tools. Put each tool back where it lives.
- 3 Keep water pots and ink trays steady. Wipe spills at once.
- 4 Walk with scissors closed and pointing down.
- 5 Talk about work kindly: what you notice, what the design is **for**.

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Shake your hands for five seconds. Press your palms together hard, then open them wide like stars. Do it three times. Now your hands are ready to make.



Picture 0.2 A tidy Year 4 kit: print block, paints, brushes, card and a small box ready to become a building.

UNIT 1 · PRINT TABLE

1

Printing for a purpose

Press once. Make many. Know why the print exists.

A print is a mark lifted from a prepared surface onto paper. Purpose is the job the print is made to do: a poster people read from the far end of the hall, a pattern, a gift tag, a badge.

◎ IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ print with three techniques and say what each one is good at
- ✓ choose colour on purpose, and line up a second colour
- ✓ design a print that has one clear job
- ✓ pull a matching set of final prints and label them
- ✓ run a print stall for a real audience

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus lays out a foam block, a tray of washable ink and a stack of clean paper.

"A print is not a one-off drawing," he says. "You cut the block once, carefully. After that, the block does the work for you."

Bruno rolls ink until the tray hisses. "The school fair opens at 14:30 on Friday," he says. "We need forty gift tags that all look like they belong together. Try drawing forty by hand. Purpose first, then press."



Picture 1.0 The print table set out before anyone touches it: foam block, ink tray, roller and paper. Look at how much clear space is left around the tray, so a wet print never lands in a puddle.

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Year 3 you pressed patterns with sponges and made repeating borders. You already know that a shape can come back again and again. This year you decide why it comes back, and you keep every press as clean as the first.

What you will fetch

- a foam sheet or half a potato, and a blunt pencil for pressing lines
- washable printing ink or thick paint, a shallow tray, a roller or sponge
- clean paper, plus scrap paper for tests
- found objects: cork, leaf, bottle lid, corrugated card
- an apron, a damp cloth and a line or rack for drying

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Press your thumb onto the table for two seconds. Press it again, but only half as hard. Which press would leave a fuller mark in ink? Do it three times and feel the difference between a firm, even press and a squashing one.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Exploring printing techniques

■ Open the door

If you could stamp one mark forty times before lunch, what mark would earn that many presses, and who would it be for?

► Here is how it works

Printing lifts ink from a prepared surface onto paper. You prepare the surface once, then repeat the press. That is the whole idea, and it is why printing is used whenever many copies must match.

Three techniques suit the Year 4 print table.

TECHNIQUE	WHAT HOLDS THE INK	BEST AT
Relief (foam or potato)	the raised parts	bold, simple shapes
Found-object	the surface of a real thing	texture and surprise
Monoprint	a smooth inked tray, drawn into	one rich, unique print

Each one has a trap. Thin lines on a relief block fill with ink and disappear. A wobbly found object slides and smudges. A monoprint cannot be repeated at all.

In a **relief** print the ink sits on the parts that stand up, so the lines you press *down* stay the colour of the paper. Beginners often expect the opposite, then wonder why their drawing came out inside out.

Monoprint starts with *mono*, which means one. You roll ink onto a tray, draw into it with a cotton bud or the wrong end of a brush, then lay paper on top. It gives one print only, because drawing into the ink destroys the picture as it prints it.



Picture 1.1 Found objects and the marks they leave: cork, leaf, bottle lid, corrugated card and half a potato. Look for the ribbed stripes from the card and the veins the leaf prints.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno makes a foam relief print of a leaf, the shape he wants on the fair tags.

- 1 He draws one simple leaf on the foam, as big as his palm, with no tiny veins.
- 2 He presses the outline and three veins in with a blunt pencil, so those lines sit lower than the surface.
- 3 He rolls a thin, even coat of ink over the block, until the roller sounds sticky rather than looking wet.
- 4 He lays paper on top and rubs the back with a flat, clean hand, from the middle outwards.
- 5 He peels the paper from one corner in one steady movement, then pegs it up.

His first press is patchy, so he re-inks and presses again without redrawing the block. By the third press the leaf is even. A block gets better as it works.



Picture 1.2 Rufus and Bruno checking three prints pulled from one foam leaf block. Look for the pressed veins staying pale, because those are the lines that sit lower than the surface.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Name the technique you will try first: _____
- 2 Press three times on scrap paper, then tick what improved by the third press.
 - ☐ the ink is even, with no bald patches
 - ☐ the peel is clean, with no smudge
 - ☐ the shape still reads from across the room
- 3 Which press was best, and why do you think so?

- 4 Draw the block you will cut in the box below, big and simple.

BLOCK IDEA

✦ **DID YOU KNOW?**

More than five hundred years ago in Mainz, in Germany, Johannes Gutenberg set pages using small metal letters. Once a page was set, it could be printed again and again. One careful setting, then many copies: the same bargain you make when you cut a printing block.

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Print your block onto three different surfaces: newspaper, brown parcel paper and white paper. Keep all three. Which surface holds the sharpest edge? A printer chooses paper on purpose too.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Using colour in printing

■ Open the door

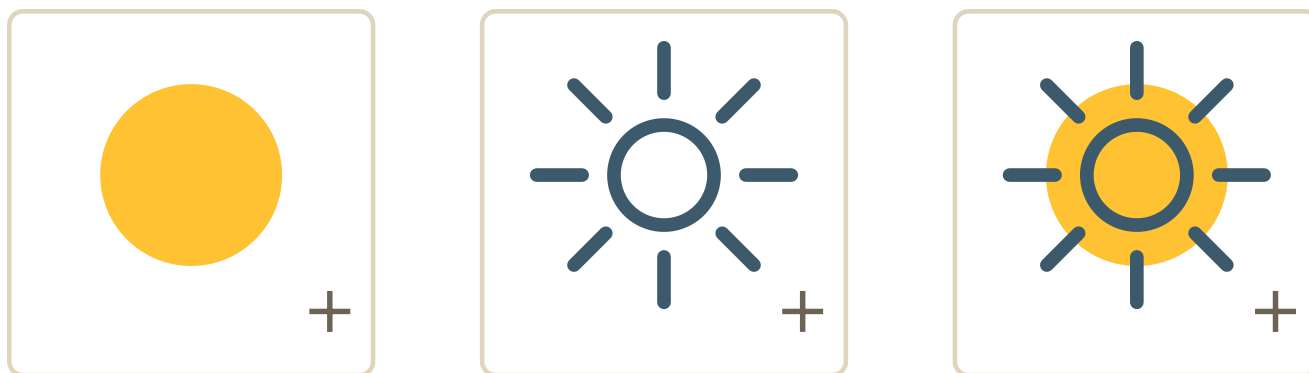
A poster must warn people about a wet floor in a busy corridor. Pale yellow on cream, or deep blue on white? Say why.

► Here is how it works

Colour in a print is chosen, not left to chance.

- **One colour** is strong, quick and clear. Most badges and logos live on one colour.
- **Two colours** need a plan: print the lighter colour first, let it dry, then print the darker one on top.
- **Contrast** is the difference between your ink and your paper, and it decides how far away your print can still be read.
- **Registration** means lining the second layer up with the first, by matching a small cross mark outside the picture.

Weak contrast makes a pretty print that nobody can read from three metres away. Strong contrast lets one shape carry the length of a hall.



Picture 1.3 The sun stamp printed in two colours: the pale layer, then the dark layer, then both together. Look at the small cross in the corner of every panel, the mark that tells you the second layer landed in the right place.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Inês prints a two-colour tile for the fair, one hundred millimetres square.

- 1 She cuts two foam blocks the same size, one for a pale square and one for the dark line pattern.
- 2 She marks a small cross on the bottom right of her paper, and the same cross on both blocks.
- 3 She prints the pale ochre square first, matching the crosses, and leaves it to dry for ten minutes.
- 4 She prints the dark blue lines on top, matching the crosses again.
- 5 Her first tile is off by about two millimetres, so she keeps it as proof and prints two more. The third is exact.

Ten minutes of drying saves a smudged tile. Ink that is still wet mixes with the next layer and turns both colours to mud.



Picture 1.4 The same stamp printed in soft yellow and then in deep blue on pale paper. Look at which of the two you can read first when you hold the page at arm's length.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose the job for this print, and circle one: poster · badge · gift tag · pattern paper
- 2 Write the lighter colour, the one you will print first: _____
- 3 Write the darker colour, the one that goes on top: _____
- 4 Print a test of each colour in the boxes below, then hold the page at arm's length.

LIGHTER TEST

DARKER TEST

Which colour still reads clearly from far away?



Picture 1.5 An old Lisbon wall where one tile design repeats across the whole front of the house. Look for the single tile shape first, and then for the bigger pattern your eye makes out of it.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The patterned wall tiles you see all over Portugal are called **azulejos**, and Lisbon has a whole museum for them, the Museu Nacional do Azulejo. A tiled wall is printing's idea in clay: design one tile, repeat it, and a plain house front turns into a pattern.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Print one shape in a colour that shouts and once in a colour that whispers. Pin both at the far end of the room. Ask a friend which one they read first, and write down what they say before you decide who was right.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Designing for a purpose

■ Open the door

What is your print **for**? If you cannot say the job in one sentence, the design is not ready to be cut.

► Here is how it works

A **purpose** is the job the print must do, and it decides everything else: the shape, the colour, the paper and the size.

THE JOB	WHO LOOKS AT IT	WHAT THAT DEMANDS
Tell people where the book fair is	a passer-by, walking	one bold shape, strong contrast
Decorate a notebook cover	one person, up close	a small repeating pattern
Thank a visitor	one person, in the hand	a neat tag, careful edges
Mark the quiet corner	a child from three metres away	a simple sign, no detail

Four steps take you from job to block.

- 1 Write the job in one sentence. If the sentence needs an "and", you may have two jobs and need two prints.
- 2 Choose **one** strong shape, because one good shape beats five weak ones.
- 3 Leave space around the shape so it can breathe. Crowded prints look shouty and read as a blur.
- 4 Test small before you commit to good paper.



Picture 1.6 Rufus's badge plan for the quiet reading corner: the open-book shape drawn big, two colour swatches beside it, and two test cards already pulled. Look at how much paper he leaves empty around the shape.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Portugal produces more cork than any other country, and cork is a printer's friend. Slice a wine cork across, cut a notch into the flat face, and you have a small stamp that fits a child's hand and prints hundreds of times.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus designs a badge for the quiet reading corner in the library at Estoril.

- 1 Job.** Help a child spot the quiet corner from the library door.
- 2 Shape.** One open book. He tries a book with a lamp and a chair, then throws that away, because three things at badge size become a smudge.
- 3 Colour.** Deep green on cream. Calm suits a quiet corner, and green still reads from the door.
- 4 Test.** Two small presses on scrap, one in each colour he is weighing up. He picks the cleaner, then cuts the final block.

He checks the badge by standing where a reader stands, not where the maker stands.

• **YOUR TURN**

Write the job of your print in one sentence, without using the word "and".

Who will look at it, and from how far away?

Sketch the one strong shape you will cut, filling the box below.

THE ONE SHAPE

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Design the same job twice: once for a poster on a wall and once for a tag in a hand. Keep the shape, change the size and the amount of empty space. Which one had to lose detail, and why?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Producing a final print

Open the door

When is a print finished: when you are bored of pressing, or when the job is done well? Who decides?

► Here is how it works

A **final print** is the best press of a planned design, on chosen paper, dried flat and labelled. A set of matching final prints is called an **edition**, and printers number them so nobody has to guess which is which.

Run the checklist before the final press.

- ☐ the job is written in one sentence
- ☐ the block is clean, with no dried ink in the pressed lines
- ☐ the ink is thin and even, sticky rather than wet
- ☐ the paper is cut and dry, with the registration cross marked
- ☐ your hands are clean for the peel
- ☐ there is space on the line or rack for the print to dry flat

Then press, peel, and hang it up. Write your name, the date and the job on the back of every print, in pencil, once it is dry.



Picture 1.7 Prints from one block pegged up to dry, with a blank label slip clipped beside each one. Look at how alike they are, because that likeness is what makes them an edition instead of a pile of separate tries.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno pulls an edition of four tags for the fair.

- 1 He cuts four cards, each 60 by 90 millimetres, and marks a cross on the back of each one.
- 2 He re-inks between every press, always the same thin coat.
- 3 Tag two comes out pale, so he sets it aside instead of pressing harder, because pressing harder squashes the foam and spreads the shape.
- 4 He prints two more, so he ends with four good tags out of six pulls.
- 5 He labels each one on the back in pencil: *leaf block, fair tag, 12 August 2026*.

Two rejects out of six is normal, and honest. An edition is the prints that matched, not every print you made.

• **YOUR TURN**

Press your final print, dry it flat, then finish these lines.

The job of this print:

How many pulls did you make, and how many matched?

What would you change if you cut the block again?

STICK YOUR FINAL PRINT HERE, OR A PHOTO OF IT

▲ **BIG CHALLENGE**

Print an edition of **four** matching invitations for one real event in your school. Number them 1 of 4, 2 of 4, 3 of 4 and 4 of 4 in pencil on the back. Anyone should be able to shuffle them and still see one design, not four attempts.

The print stall

◆ FINAL PROJECT: RUN THE PRINT STALL

The school fair opens at 14:30 on Friday in the hall. Your table sells nothing and gives everything away: printed gift tags, pattern paper, and one poster that tells people where your table is.

What your stall needs

ITEM	HOW MANY	ITS JOB
Poster	1	bring a visitor across the hall
Gift tags	8 matching	something to take away
Pattern paper	2 sheets	show the block repeating
Label card	1	name the block and the colours you chose

Plan it here

My block will be: _____ My colours: _____

The poster's job, in one sentence:

Sketch your poster small, with the shape big enough to see from far away.

POSTER PLAN

Run it, then answer

How many visitors stopped at your table? _____

What did the poster do well?



Picture 1.8 A print stall at a school fair: one poster on the board, a stack of matching tags, pattern paper and two visitors waiting. Look at how the poster's single shape is readable from further away than anything on the table.

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I printed with at least two techniques and can name what each is good at.
- ☐ I chose my colours on purpose, and I can say why.
- ☐ My print has one clear job, in one sentence.
- ☐ I pulled a matching edition and labelled it.

The hardest part was:

Next time I would start by:

🕒 WHAT CAN YOU DO NOW?

- ✓ explain the difference between a relief print and a monoprint
- ✓ line up a second colour using a registration cross
- ✓ say who a print is for, and how far away they stand
- ✓ tell an edition apart from a pile of tries

→ WHAT GOES TO THE STUDIO SHOW

The studio show at the end of this book asks for one piece from every table. Keep these three safe in your folder, because the print table's evidence comes from this unit.

- ✓ your final print, with its one-sentence job written on the back
- ✓ one test sheet that shows three presses of the same block
- ✓ the poster from your print stall, or a photograph of the stall

◇ WORDS YOU NOW OWN

print · relief print · monoprint · found-object print · purpose · contrast · registration · edition · azulejo

UNIT 2 · PAINT TABLE

2

Approaches to painting

Brush, colour, texture, and the real thing in front of you.

Painting is more than filling a shape in. How you hold the brush, how you mix the colour and how you build the surface all change what the picture says.

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ use five brush techniques and say what each one is good for
- ✓ mix a colour on purpose, for a mood or to match something real
- ✓ build texture with paint instead of drawing every detail
- ✓ paint from observation, with the real thing in front of you
- ✓ finish a painted panel for the studio wall

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno sets out two brushes, a water pot and three tubes: red, yellow and blue.

"Same wall, different brushes," he says, looking at the mural sketch. "A wide brush covers. A thin tip draws a branch. A dry brush scratches bark."

Rufus lines up the tubes. "And three colours are enough. If I want the green of that leaf, I mix it. There is no tube in the world with exactly that green in it."



Picture 2.0 The paint table before work starts: red, yellow and blue on the palette, three brushes, a water pot and a blank board. Look at the empty board, because every colour is tried there before it goes anywhere near the painting.

 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1 you chose a colour on purpose, so a print would carry across a room. Painting asks the same question and then a harder one: not only which colour, but how wet, how thick, and with which brush.

What you will fetch

- watercolour or ready-mix paint in red, yellow and blue, plus white
- a flat brush and a round brush, and one old brush for dry work
- two water pots, one for washing out and one kept clean
- thick paper that will not cockle, plus scrap paper for tests
- a rag or kitchen paper, a palette or an old white plate, an apron
- one real object to paint from: fruit, a jug, a plant, a shell

 WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Load a brush with clean water and paint a wet stripe. Now touch one dot of colour into the wet stripe and watch it travel by itself. That travelling is what a wash does, and you steer it by how wet the paper is.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

Experimenting with brush techniques **Open the door**

Which brush would you use for a wide evening sky, and which for a thin fence wire? What happens if you swap them?

 Here is how it works

The brush is not one tool. It is five, and the difference is in how much water you carry and how you land the stroke.

TECHNIQUE	HOW IT LOOKS	TRY IT FOR
Wash	thin, even, wet	sky, water, a large background
Dry brush	scratchy, broken	bark, grass, a rough wall
Dab	soft, repeated spots	leaves, blossom, clouds
Line with the tip	thin and controlled	twigs, wires, window frames
Scumble	broken colour over dry paint	weather, age, worn stone

Two habits make all five work. Keep one water pot clean, because grey water turns every colour to mud. And let a layer dry before you put another on top, unless you actually want the colours to run together.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Watercolour dries lighter than it looks when it is wet, and thick paint dries darker. Painters learn their own materials by keeping a test strip beside the work and comparing it after it dries, instead of trusting the wet colour.



Picture 2.1 Five brush marks on one test strip: wash, dry brush, dab, thin line and scumble. Look at how much white paper still shows through the dry brush mark.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno paints the top half of the mural sketch: a soft sky above a rough wall.

- 1 He wets the sky area with clean water first, so the colour can spread evenly.
- 2 He drops in blue at the top and lets it travel down into the damp paper.
- 3 He waits. The sky dries about a shade lighter than it looked when wet.
- 4 He loads an old brush, wipes most of the paint off on the rag, then drags it sideways across the wall area.
- 5 The dry brush skips over the paper and leaves broken marks, which read as rough stone.

He does not paint the wall while the sky is wet. Wet meeting wet would blur the line where the wall begins.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Make a test strip with all five techniques, one in each box below.
- 2 Label each box as you go, so you can name what you did.
- 3 Which technique surprised you most?

WASH

DRY BRUSH

DAB

THIN LINE

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Paint the same simple tree twice: once with a thin brush for every branch, once by dabbing the whole crown as one soft shape. Which one looks more like a tree from across the room?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Mixing and using colour

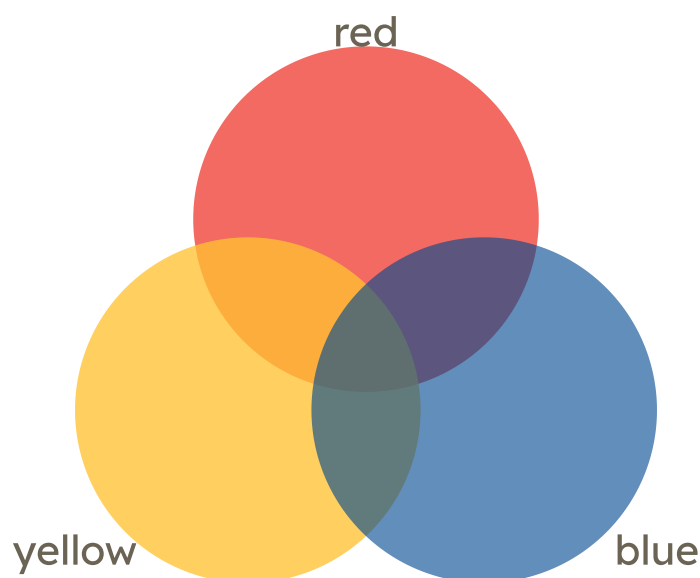
■ Open the door

Can you mix a grey without opening a tube labelled grey? What would you put in it?

► Here is how it works

Three colours and white will take you almost anywhere.

- **Primary** colours are red, yellow and blue. You cannot mix them from anything else.
- **Secondary** colours come from two primaries: orange, green and purple.
- A **tint** is a colour with white added, or with more water in watercolour.
- A **shade** is a colour with a little of its opposite added, which is how you get a rich grey instead of a dead one.
- **Warm** colours (red, orange, yellow) feel busy and close. **Cool** colours (blue, green, violet) feel calm and far away.



Picture 2.2 Three primary colours laid over each other. Look at the three places where two circles cross, because that is where orange, green and purple appear without any tube of orange, green or purple.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Inês mixes the exact green of a bay leaf from the studio window.

- 1 She starts with yellow, because a leaf green is mostly yellow, not mostly blue.
- 2 She adds blue a little at a time, on the tip of the brush, stirring between each touch.
- 3 She paints a test dab on scrap paper and holds it right beside the real leaf.
- 4 Her mix is too bright, so she adds the smallest touch of red, which calms it down.
- 5 She writes the recipe next to the dab: *yellow, a little blue, a speck of red.*

Holding the test beside the real leaf is the whole trick. A colour that looks right on the palette can look wrong on the paper.



Picture 2.3 Bruno painting birds onto the mural, with the palette in front: a calm blue-green pool and an excited orange-red pool. Look at how far apart the two pools sit, so a brush moving between them does not drag one colour into the other.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Mix a **calm** colour and paint it in the first box below.
- 2 Mix an **excited** colour and paint it in the second box.
- 3 Write what you added to change the mood:

- 4 Mix a grey from your three primaries, with no white. Where did you use it?

CALM MIX

EXCITED MIX

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Ultramarine, the deep blue of many old paintings, was once ground from lapis lazuli, a stone carried across the sea from far away. It cost more than gold, so painters saved it for the most important part of a picture. Today the same blue comes from a tube and costs very little.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Paint one small square using only mixes of two primaries. No third tube, no white. See how many different colours you can pull out of just two.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Exploring textures in painting

■ Open the door

How can paint tell you a wall is rough, without drawing a single brick?

► Here is how it works

Texture is how a surface seems to feel. In paint you suggest it rather than draw it, and there are four reliable ways.

- 1 Dry brush over a dry layer, so the paper breaks the stroke up.
- 2 Dab with a sponge or a crumpled rag, which gives a random, natural speckle.
- 3 Put thick paint next to a thin wash, so one area sits up and the other sinks back.
- 4 Leave tiny gaps of white paper, which read as sparkle on stone, water or fur.

Painters call paint laid on thickly enough to stand up off the surface **impasto**. You can see the ridges of the brush in it, and it catches real light.



Picture 2.4 Rufus and Bruno painting leaves straight onto a rough plaster wall outdoors. Look at how the wall's own grain breaks every stroke into pieces, which is exactly what dry brushing imitates on paper.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno paints a brick wall without painting bricks.

- 1 He lays a light wash of warm grey over the whole wall area and lets it dry.
- 2 He dry-brushes a slightly darker tone across it in short sideways strokes.
- 3 He adds a few thin darker lines where mortar would run, but only a few.
- 4 He stops. Three suggestions read as a wall; forty outlined bricks read as a chart.

The hard part of texture is stopping. Every extra mark makes the surface busier and the wall less believable.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Paint a **smooth** surface in the left half of the box below.
- 2 Paint a **rough** surface in the right half, using a different technique.
- 3 Name the technique you used for rough: _____
- 4 Which half took fewer marks to look right?

SMOOTH, THEN ROUGH

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Find three real surfaces in your classroom: a window, a jumper, a wooden table. Paint a small patch of each so a friend can guess which is which without being told.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Working from observation

Open the door

What changes if you paint a plant from memory instead of from the plant on the table in front of you?

► **Here is how it works**

Observation means looking at the real thing while you paint, not before you paint.

The loop is short and you repeat it: look, paint a little, look again, correct.

Order matters as much as looking.

- 1 Big shapes first, blocked in loosely, with no detail at all.
- 2 Edges second, deciding which are sharp and which are soft.
- 3 Colour matched by testing beside the object, as you did in 2.2.
- 4 Tiny highlights last, and only a few of them.

The commonest mistake is starting with the detail you like best, usually a highlight or an outline, and then discovering the big shape underneath it is the wrong size.



Picture 2.5 A still life set up on the table with a half-finished painting propped beside it. Look at how the painting keeps the big shapes loose while the real objects sit in plain view.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus paints a lemon from the fruit bowl, in twenty minutes.

- 1 He turns the lemon until the shape is interesting, then leaves it alone.
- 2 He blocks in the whole lemon as one flat yellow oval, wrong in places, and does not fuss.
- 3 He mixes a shadow colour from yellow with a speck of blue, and puts it where the lemon curves away from the window.
- 4 He compares, and finds his oval too round, so he corrects the left edge.
- 5 He leaves one small patch of white paper as the shine, without painting white over the top.

His painting looks like that lemon on that day, which is what observation gets you and memory does not.

**· DID YOU KNOW ?**

Josefa de Óbidos painted in Portugal more than three hundred years ago , and among her best known works are still lifes : bowls of fruit , flowers and sweets , painted from close looking . Painting the ordinary things on a table is an old and serious job , not a warm - up .

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Set one real object on the table where you can see it clearly.
- 2 Paint it in the box below, big shapes first, working the loop.
- 3 Write one colour you matched from life: _____
- 4 Write one thing you corrected after looking again:

OBSERVATION PAINTING

▲ **BIG CHALLENGE**

Paint the same object twice: once in twenty minutes and once in five. Keep both. The quick one usually catches the big shape better, and that is worth knowing about your own hands.

The studio wall panel

◆ FINAL PROJECT: PAINT A PANEL FOR THE STUDIO WALL

One panel, painted by you, to hang with the others. It has to use every technique from this unit, which is why the subject is a view rather than a single object.

What the panel needs

PART OF THE PANEL	TECHNIQUE IT MUST USE	WHY
Sky or background	wash	one even area holds the picture together
A rough surface	dry brush or scumble	shows texture without drawing detail
Foliage or pattern	dab	soft repeated shapes, quickly made
Thin details	line with the brush tip	wires, twigs, frames, last of all

Plan it here

My view will be: _____ My three colours: _____

Which part gets the wash, and why that part?

Sketch the big shapes only, in the box below. No detail yet.

BIG SHAPES PLAN

When it is dry

One thing that worked:

One thing I would paint differently:



Picture 2.6 A finished panel standing against the studio wall while Rufus and Bruno look it over. Look for the three techniques of this unit in one picture: the washed sky, the dry-brushed stone, the dabbed foliage.

→ **WHAT GOES TO THE STUDIO SHOW**

The paint table's evidence for the studio show comes from this unit. Keep these three safe in your folder.

- ✓ your studio wall panel, dry and flat
- ✓ the brush test strip with all five techniques labelled
- ✓ your observation painting, with the colour you matched written beside it

🕒 HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can name five brush techniques and what each is for.
- ☐ I mixed a colour on purpose, and I can say what I put in it.
- ☐ I showed texture with paint, not with outlines.
- ☐ I painted something real while looking at it.

The technique I trust most now:

The one I want more practice with:

🕒 WHAT CAN YOU DO NOW?

- ✓ choose a brush technique to fit the surface you are painting
- ✓ mix a secondary colour, a tint and a shade from three primaries
- ✓ keep one water pot clean, and say why it matters
- ✓ paint from observation using the look, paint, look again loop

◇ WORDS YOU NOW OWN

wash · dry brush · dab · scumble · impasto · primary · secondary · tint · shade · observation

UNIT 3 · LINE TABLE

3

Drawing with perspective

Space that goes back. Figures that move.

Perspective is a small set of rules that make flat paper feel deep. Dynamism is what makes a drawn figure look as though it could move in the next second.

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ find the horizon line and the vanishing point in a real view
- ✓ draw in one-point and two-point perspective
- ✓ draw figures that look active instead of stiff
- ✓ use line weight and tone to push things near or far
- ✓ put space and movement together in one finished drawing

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus draws a long corridor with every floor line running to the same point.

"Your eye believes it," he says. "Nothing on this paper is far away, and yet it looks far away."

Bruno is sketching a fox mid-jump, fast, on cheap paper. "Straight legs give you a statue," he says. "Bent legs give you a jump. Same fox, two seconds of drawing apart."



Picture 3.0 Rufus at the line table, with one sheet carrying both jobs of this unit: a ruled corridor running back to a point, and a loose bear sketched beside it. Look at the two kinds of line, one patient and straight, the other fast and curved.

 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 2 you pushed things back with paint, by making far surfaces paler and softer. Unit 3 does the same job with line: where the pencil goes, how hard you press, and where the lines meet.

What you will fetch

- a hard pencil for construction lines and a soft pencil for tone
- a ruler, a rubber, and scrap paper for fast sketching
- a viewfinder cut from card, about the size of a postcard
- a window or a corridor you are allowed to look down
- your sketchbook, for gesture drawings that nobody will judge

 WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Hold your pencil loosely and draw twenty curves across a page in ten seconds, without lifting your hand between them. Loose curves come from the shoulder and are what a moving figure needs. Tight, careful lines come from the fingers and are what a ruled corridor needs.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

Understanding one- and two-point perspective **Open the door**

Railway tracks stay exactly the same distance apart all the way along. Why do they look as though they meet?

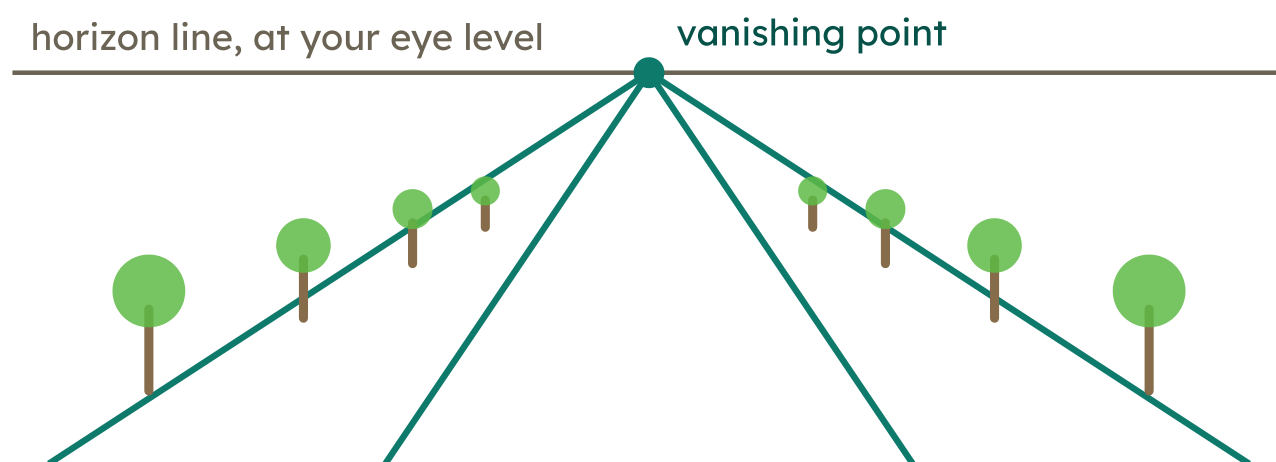
 Here is how it works

Four words do the whole job.

- The **horizon line** sits at your eye level. Not the top of the page, and not the ground: exactly where your eyes are.

- A **vanishing point** is a place on the horizon where lines that are really parallel appear to meet.
- **One-point perspective** uses a single vanishing point, and you get it when you look straight down a road, a corridor or a room.
- **Two-point perspective** uses two, and you get it when you look at the corner of a building or a box.

Things also get smaller as they go back, and they overlap. Those two facts do as much work as the ruled lines.



Picture 3.1 One-point perspective built in four moves: horizon, vanishing point, road edges, then trees. Look at how the trees shrink and climb towards the horizon at the same time, because both happen as things go away from you.

✦ **DID YOU KNOW?**

The rules on this page were worked out in Florence about six hundred years ago, by builders and painters who wanted walls to look like real rooms. Before that, pictures showed important people large and unimportant people small, whatever the distance.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus draws the corridor outside the studio, in one-point perspective.

- 1 He holds a pencil level with his eyes and draws the horizon line there, low on the page, because he is sitting down.
- 2 He marks one vanishing point on that line, off to the left, where the corridor actually runs.
- 3 He rules the floor edges and the top of the wall from the near corners to that point.
- 4 He draws the doors, each one narrower than the last, with their tops and bottoms on lines to the same point.
- 5 He rubs out the construction lines that run past the doors, and leaves the ones he needs.

The drawing looks right because everything obeys one point. The moment a door leans off to its own point, the corridor bends.



Picture 3.2 A narrow street seen straight down its length. Look for the lines that are really parallel, the roof lines, the doorways and the rows of cobbles, and follow each one until it meets the others.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Rule a horizon line at eye level and mark one vanishing point on it.
- 2 Draw a road or corridor going back to that point, in the box below.
- 3 Add four things that get smaller as they go back: trees, doors, lamps, windows.
- 4 Write where your vanishing point is: _____

ONE-POINT DRAWING

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Now the corner of a box, with two vanishing points, one at each end of the horizon. Two sides of the box run away from you, and the vertical edges stay upright. Nothing else changes.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Drawing dynamic figures

■ Open the door

Can you tell a walking person from a standing person using only three lines?

► Here is how it works

A **dynamic** figure looks as if it is in the middle of something.

- 1 Start with the **line of action**: one long curve through the whole body, from head to foot.
- 2 Hang the big shapes on that curve, and keep the head simple.
- 3 Bend the joints. Straight arms and straight legs read as furniture.
- 4 Overlap the limbs, so one arm passes in front of the body instead of beside it.
- 5 Catch a moment: mid-step, mid-reach, mid-turn, never a pose that could hold still all day.

A **gesture drawing** is a fast sketch, often under a minute, that goes for the movement and ignores the face. Artists fill pages with them before starting a careful drawing, the way you shake your hands out before you write.



Picture 3.3 A sheet of quick studies: Rufus and Bruno walking with buckets, climbing a ladder and reaching up to paint. Look at the bend in every arm and leg, because that bend is what makes a drawn body look busy instead of posed.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno draws Rufus carrying a heavy bucket across the studio.

- 1 He draws the line of action first, a curve leaning away from the bucket.
- 2 He marks the shoulders as one short line and the hips as another, tilting the opposite way.
- 3 He adds bent arms and legs, one leg taking the weight and one swinging.
- 4 He overlaps: the far arm disappears behind the body, and he does not draw it in full.
- 5 He spends the last ten seconds on the bucket, because the bucket explains the lean.

The whole sketch takes under a minute. Bruno makes four of them and keeps the one where the lean reads best.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Ask a friend to hold an action pose for forty-five seconds, then swap.
- 2 Draw four gesture sketches, one to a box, going for the movement only.
- 3 Circle the one where the movement reads best from across the table.
- 4 Write what makes that one work:

1 WALKING

2 REACHING

3 TURNING

4 YOUR CHOICE

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Draw the same figure twice: once standing to attention, once mid-run. Use the same number of lines for both. The second one should be quicker to draw and quicker to read.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Using line, tone and shading for depth

■ Open the door

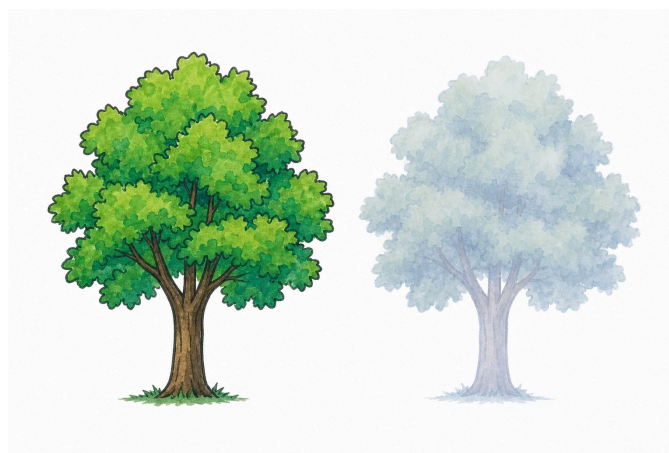
Two trees, the same size on your paper. One is dark with a sharp edge, one is pale and soft. Which one does your eye put closer, and why?

► Here is how it works

Perspective is not the only way to build depth. Line and tone do it without a single ruled line.

TOOL	NEAR	FAR
Line weight	thicker, pressed harder	thinner, lighter
Tone	darker, stronger contrast	paler, weaker contrast
Detail	edges and texture visible	shapes only
Overlap	in front, covering	behind, partly hidden

Far things really do look paler and bluer, because you are looking through more air to see them. Painters call it aerial perspective, and it works on a drawing exactly as well as on a mountain.



Near and far : the same tree , dark and sharp , or pale and soft .



Picture 3.4 Rufus and Bruno painting a wall, with the whole valley behind them. Look past them at the hills: the near slopes are green and clearly edged, the far ones pale and blue-grey, which is depth built out of tone alone.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

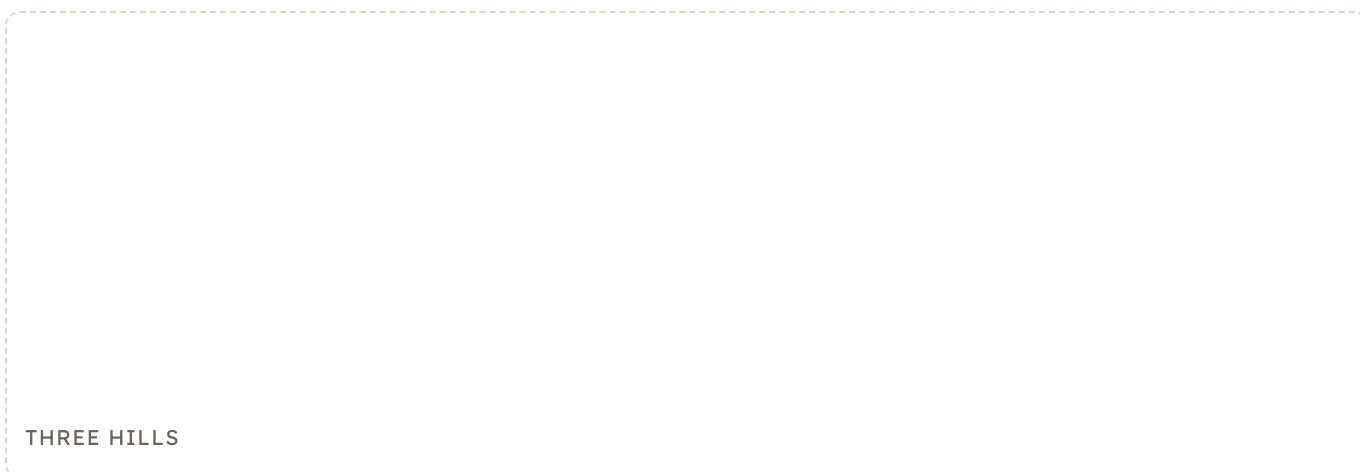
The Portuguese painter Maria Helena Vieira da Silva filled her pictures with small squares and crossing lines that seem to run away from you, like a city or a library seen from high up. She built depth out of pattern rather than out of ruled corridors.



Depth built from pattern: a city seen from high up, like Vieira da Silva.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Draw three hills, one behind the other, in the box below.
- 2 Press hardest on the near hill and lightest on the far one.
- 3 Shade the near hill with strong tone, and leave the far one almost bare.
- 4 Which tool moved the hills back for you, line weight or tone?



THREE HILLS

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Take a drawing you have already made and push one part further back, using only a rubber. Lightening is a drawing tool, not a mistake tool.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Combining perspective and movement in composition

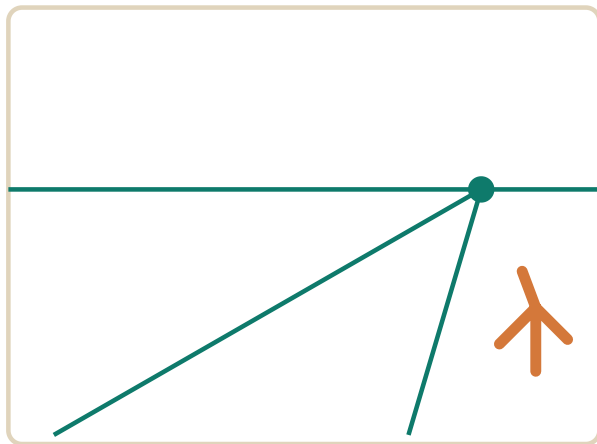
■ Open the door

If a figure runs towards the vanishing point, do they look faster or slower than a figure running across the page?

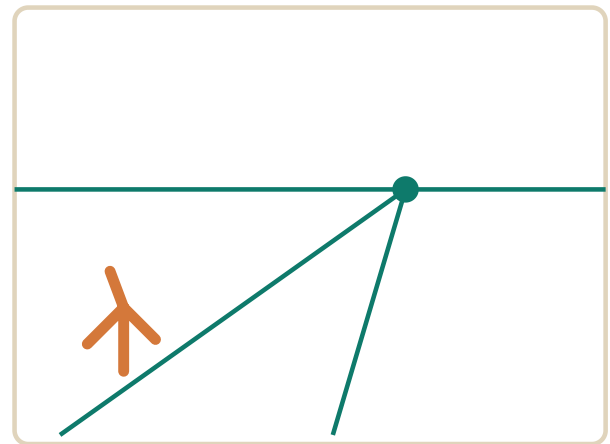
► Here is how it works

A **composition** is where you put things on purpose. Space and movement can help each other.

- 1 Put the vanishing point off centre, so the picture is not split down the middle.
- 2 Send the movement along the perspective lines, into the depth or out of it.
- 3 Leave breathing room in front of a moving figure, so they have somewhere to go.
- 4 Keep the near things dark and detailed, and let the far things fade, as in 3.3.
- 5 Check the whole thing from across the room before you add any detail.



running into the edge



running into space

Picture 3.5 The same figure and the same corridor, twice. Look at the gap in front of the runner: on the left there is nowhere to go, and on the right the movement has room, which is the whole difference.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Inês plans a drawing of the market street in Cascais, with one figure running.

- 1 She draws three thumbnails the size of a matchbox, spending a minute on each.
- 2 In the first, the vanishing point sits dead centre and the street looks like a tunnel.
- 3 She moves it right in the second thumbnail, and the street immediately looks like a place.
- 4 She puts the runner on the left, moving right, with space ahead. The eye follows the runner into the depth.
- 5 Only then does she start the full drawing, copying her third thumbnail.

Three small thumbnails cost her three minutes and saved a whole afternoon of a drawing that would not have worked.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Draw three thumbnails in the boxes below, moving the vanishing point in each.
- 2 Choose one, and write why you chose it:
- 3 Draw your final composition big, in the box at the bottom.
- 4 Mark your vanishing point with a small cross when you have finished.

THUMBNAIL 1

THUMBNAIL 2

FINAL COMPOSITION



Picture 3.6 A finished Year 4 drawing pinned up above the line table. Look for the two things this unit asked for at once: a street that goes back, and a figure caught mid-stride.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Draw the view from a window in your school, in one-point perspective, with one moving figure in it. Be ready to point at your vanishing point and say what is in front of the figure.

◎ HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can find the horizon line in a real view.
- ☐ My lines run to a vanishing point that I could point at.
- ☐ My figure looks as if it is moving.
- ☐ I used line weight or tone to push something back.

The hardest part was:

Next time I would start by:

🕒 WHAT CAN YOU DO NOW?

- ✓ place a horizon line at eye level, not at the top of the page
- ✓ build a street or corridor from one vanishing point
- ✓ draw a fast gesture sketch that reads as movement
- ✓ make one thing look further away using only line weight and tone

→ WHAT GOES TO THE STUDIO SHOW

The line table's evidence for the studio show comes from this unit. Keep these three safe in your folder.

- ✓ your one-point drawing, with the vanishing point marked
- ✓ the sheet of four gesture sketches, with your best one circled
- ✓ your final composition, showing space and movement together

◇ WORDS YOU NOW OWN

horizon line · vanishing point · one-point perspective · two-point perspective · line of action · gesture drawing · line weight · tone · overlap · composition

UNIT 4 • BUILD TABLE

4

Architecture in 3D

Forms that stand. Spaces people could use.

Architecture is the design of buildings and of the spaces between them. In this unit your work leaves the paper: it has height, width and depth, and it has to stand up on its own.

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ name the forms a building is made of, in a real street
- ✓ build a model that stands up without being held
- ✓ choose materials and textures for what they do, not only how they look
- ✓ design for a purpose and for someone's size
- ✓ finish an architectural model for the studio show

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno puts a shoebox, a roll of corrugated card and a lump of clay on the table.

"Everything here is flat or lumpy," he says. "By Friday one of them has to be a building that stands on its own."

Rufus taps the table twice with a knuckle. "That is the test," he says. "If a tap knocks it over, it is a picture of a building, not a building."



Picture 4.0 The build table before anything is made: boxes, corrugated card, tape, clay and a small tower already in progress. Look at the tower's base, because it is wider than everything above it.

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 3 you made flat paper look deep. Now the depth is real. The same words come back, though: a model still has a near side and a far side, and it still needs a purpose, exactly like your print in Unit 1.

What you will fetch

- small boxes, card, corrugated card, and cardboard tubes
- air-dry clay or plasticine, and a board to work on
- masking tape, glue, and safety scissors
- a ruler and a pencil for marking before cutting
- scraps for texture: sandpaper, foil, fabric, string, lolly sticks
- one small figure, clay or toy, to give your building a size

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Roll a sheet of paper into a tube and stand it up. Now press down on it gently with one finger. Try again with the paper folded into a zigzag instead. The zigzag holds more weight, and you have just felt why shape matters more than material.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

Studying architectural forms

🏠 Open the door

What is the difference between a wall that only looks nice and a wall that is also holding up a roof?

▶ Here is how it works

Buildings are put together from a small set of **forms**. Once you can name them, you can see them everywhere.

FORM	WHAT IT DOES	EASY MODEL IDEA
Column	carries weight downwards	a rolled tube of card
Arch	spans an opening and pushes out sideways	a card curve on two posts
Dome	covers a space with no columns inside	half a clay ball, or paper strips
Beam	bridges the gap between two supports	a flat strip of card
Wall	divides space, and often carries the roof	a folded card plane

An arch is the clever one. It carries the weight of everything above it by pushing outwards into whatever stands at its feet, which is why an arch needs something solid at each side.



Picture 4.1 Five forms drawn as clear shapes: column, arch, dome, beam and wall. Look at the arch, and follow the load down through the curve into the two posts.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The Águas Livres aqueduct carries water into Lisbon across a valley on tall stone arches, and it was finished more than two hundred years ago. Nothing holds those arches up except their own shape and the stone at their feet.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus names the forms on one building front, from the pavement opposite.

- 1 He starts at the ground and works up, because that is the order the weight travels.
- 2 Two **columns** each side of the door, doing real work, not decoration.
- 3 One **arch** over the door, with its feet landing on those columns.
- 4 A flat stone **beam** over each window, carrying the wall above it.
- 5 The **wall** itself, and a tiled roof resting on it.

He writes the five words on his sketch, next to the parts they belong to.
Naming is half of seeing.



Picture 4.2 Rufus and Bruno on an architecture walk, looking up at a painted house front with a round arched doorway under a tiled roof. Look for the point where the curve of the arch lands on the stone posts at its feet, because that is where the load changes direction.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Look out of a window, or walk with an adult, and find three forms from the table.
- 2 Write them here:

- 3 Sketch one building corner in the box below, and label at least two forms on it.
- 4 Which form is doing the most work in your sketch?

BUILDING CORNER, WITH LABELS

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Find an arch and a beam over two openings of about the same width. Which one is made of more pieces? Which one looks as though it is working harder?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Constructing simple 3D models

■ Open the door

When does a model stop being a drawing and start being a building?

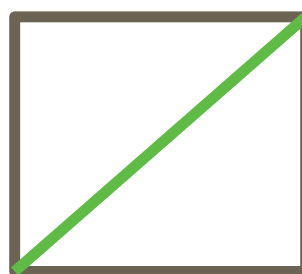
► Here is how it works

A **3D model** has height, width and depth, and it must stand without a hand on it.

- 1 Decide the purpose first: shelter, bridge, tower, market stall, bus stop.
- 2 Make the base wider than the top, so the weight sits low.
- 3 Cut and fold before you join, and mark every cut with a pencil first.
- 4 Join properly: a slot is stronger than tape, and tape is stronger than glue in a hurry.
- 5 Add a triangle wherever a corner wobbles, because a triangle cannot change shape.
- 6 Test with the knuckle tap, then fix what moved.



four sides: leans over



one diagonal: holds

Picture 4.3 The same square frame twice. Look at the single diagonal on the right, the only difference between the two, and the reason the right-hand frame cannot lean.

✧ **DID YOU KNOW?**

A triangle is the only straight-sided shape that cannot be pushed out of shape without breaking or bending a side. That is why you find triangles inside cranes, roofs, bridges and pylons, and why one strip of card across a corner rescues a wobbly model.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus builds a two-level shelter for a small clay figure.

- 1 Purpose written first: somewhere the figure can sit out of the rain.
- 2 Base cut wide, wider than he thinks he needs, from double card.
- 3 Four walls marked, cut, and one door opening cut out before any joining.
- 4 Roof folded from a single piece, kept light, because a heavy roof pushes walls outwards.
- 5 Knuckle tap: the back corner shifts, so he tapes a card triangle inside it.
- 6 Second tap: nothing moves. He puts the figure inside and checks it fits sitting down.

The figure is the real test. A shelter that the figure cannot get into is a sculpture, not a shelter.



Picture 4.4 Rufus and Bruno working on a card house with an arched door cut into it. Look at the base board, which is wider than the walls it carries, and at the door, which is sized for someone to walk through.

• **YOUR TURN**

1 Write the purpose of your model in one sentence:

2 Build it, then give it the knuckle tap.

3 Tick what you had to fix, and be honest.

- ☐ the base was too narrow
- ☐ a corner wobbled and needed a triangle
- ☐ the roof was too heavy for the walls
- ☐ nothing moved on the first tap

4 Sketch your model from the front, in the box below, before you decorate it.

MODEL, FROM THE FRONT

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Build a bridge from one sheet of card that carries a full pencil case across a gap of twenty centimetres. Fold, do not add material. Shape is your only tool.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Experimenting with materials and textures

Open the door

Would a roof of smooth foil tell you the same story as a roof of ridged card? Which building would you rather shelter in?

Here is how it works

Every material says something before anyone reads a label.

MATERIAL	WHAT IT SAYS	GOOD FOR
Corrugated card	ridged, rough, weathered	roof tiles, ploughed ground, old stone
Smooth white card	new, clean, precise	modern walls, glass fronts
Clay	heavy, hand-made, ancient	thick walls, domes, chimneys
Foil	shiny, cold, machine-made	glass, water, metal roofs
Sandpaper	gritty, dry, hard	pavement, plaster, rock

Two rules keep a model from turning into a craft pile. Choose a material for the job it does, and use no more than three across one building, or the eye gives up.



Picture 4.5 Two wall samples side by side: ridged corrugated card and smooth painted plaster. Look at how the light behaves on each, catching on the ridges and sliding over the smooth face.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno chooses the surfaces for his market stall model.

- 1 Walls: smooth card, because a market stall is scrubbed clean every morning.
- 2 Roof: corrugated card, ridges running downhill, so the rain would run off the way the ridges point.
- 3 Counter: a strip of sandpaper, which reads as worn stone at model size.
- 4 He tries foil for the roof first, and rejects it. Shiny reads as new, and his stall is meant to be old.
- 5 Three materials, and he stops there.

The ridges pointing downhill matter. Turned the other way, they would hold water, and anyone who has seen a real roof would feel that something was wrong without knowing why.

● YOUR TURN

Choose three materials for your building and write what each one says.

- 1 Material one: _____ says: _____
- 2 Material two: _____ says: _____
- 3 Material three: _____ says: _____

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Make the same small wall twice, once in clay and once in smooth card. Photograph both, or draw them. Which one looks older, and what exactly made it look older?

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Completing a 3D architectural project

■ Open the door

What would a visitor need to understand about your building in ten seconds, without you standing beside it?

► Here is how it works

A finished **architectural project** answers four questions, and you should be able to point at the answers on the model.

- 1 Who is it for, and what size are they? Your clay figure settles this.
- 2 What is its purpose, in one sentence, as in Unit 1?
- 3 Which forms is it built from, using the words from 4.1?
- 4 Why these materials, using the reasons from 4.3?

Then it needs finishing properly: no raw torn edges, no tape doing a job glue should do, and a label card that names the building and its purpose.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Architects build small models even when the real building will be enormous, because a model shows problems that drawings hide: a door in the wrong place, a shadow where a window was meant to give light, stairs with nowhere to land.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Inês finishes her bus shelter model for the studio show.

- 1 She checks her figure sits on the bench with head clear of the roof, and lowers the bench.
- 2 She trims every torn edge with scissors and folds the raw card under.
- 3 She replaces two strips of tape with glue, and hides the join behind a column.
- 4 She writes a label card: *Bus shelter for the school gate, so waiting is dry and you can see the road.*
- 5 She sets it on the table, walks six steps away, and looks at it from a visitor's height.



• YOUR TURN

1 Purpose of your building, one sentence:

2 Two forms you used: _____ and _____

3 Who it is for, and how you know it fits them:

4 Draw your finished model from the side, in the box below, with the figure in place.

FINISHED MODEL, FROM THE SIDE

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Write your label card twice: once for a visitor of your own age, and once for an adult. Keep both on the table and watch which one people actually read.

The studio show

◆ FINAL PROJECT: THE BUILD TABLE AT THE STUDIO SHOW

Four tables meet at the studio show: print, paint, line and build. Your building represents the build table, so it has to stand on its own and explain itself.

The final check, before it goes on the table

CHECK	WHY IT MATTERS
It stands after a knuckle tap	a model that needs a hand is not finished
The figure fits, sitting or standing	the building has a real size, not a guessed one
Two named forms are visible	it shows what you learnt in 4.1
No more than three materials	the eye can read it
No raw edges, no emergency tape	finishing is part of the work
A label card, naming it and its purpose	it speaks when you are not there

Plan the table

My building is called: _____

Its purpose, in one sentence:

Where will a visitor stand to see it best, and why there?

Sketch your part of the table, showing the model, the figure and the label card.

THE BUILD TABLE PLAN

After the show

What did visitors ask about first?

What would you change if you built it again?



Picture 4.6 The build table at the end of the year: a shelter, a bridge, a tower and a market stall standing together, with a small figure sitting on the shelter bench. Look at that figure, because it is the only thing in the picture that tells you how big any of these buildings are.

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ My model stands on its own after a knuckle tap.
- ☐ I can name two architectural forms I used.
- ☐ I chose my materials for a reason I can say out loud.
- ☐ My building fits the figure it was built for.

The hardest part was:

The part I am most pleased with:

© WHAT CAN YOU DO NOW?

- ✓ name column, arch, dome, beam and wall in a real street
- ✓ build a model with a base that keeps it standing
- ✓ brace a wobbling corner with a triangle, and say why it works
- ✓ choose three materials for what they say, and stop at three

→ WHAT GOES TO THE STUDIO SHOW

The build table's evidence comes from this unit. Bring these three to the show.

- ✓ your finished model, standing, with its clay figure
- ✓ the labelled sketch of a real building corner from 4.1
- ✓ your label card, naming the building and its purpose

◇ WORDS YOU NOW OWN

architecture · column · arch · dome · beam · wall · base · brace · corrugated · label card

Studio words

See the full list in the glossary section printed with this book (04-GLOSSARY-01.md in the manuscript). Quick refresh:

perspective · vanishing point · purpose · relief print · texture · architecture · composition · observation · dynamism · wash

Answers

Open making has no single right answer, so the dashed boxes are never marked here. What follows is the answer where a question has one, and what a strong answer shows where it does not.

Unit 1 Printing for a purpose

1.1 Exploring printing techniques

- In a relief print the ink sits on the raised parts, so any line you press down stays the colour of the paper.
- A monoprint cannot be repeated, because drawing into the ink destroys the picture in the act of printing it. *Mono* means one.
- A found-object print takes the surface of a real thing, so corrugated card gives ribbed stripes and a leaf gives its veins.
- Your turn, question 3: a strong answer points at evidence rather than a feeling, for example "the third press, because the edge is sharp and there are no bald patches".

1.2 Using colour in printing

- Open the door: deep blue on white. The contrast is strong, so the warning still reads from the far end of a busy corridor. Pale yellow on cream nearly disappears at that distance.

- Your turn: the darker of the two colours almost always reads first from across the room, because it differs more from the paper.
- The second colour is lined up by matching the small registration cross, and the lighter colour is printed first so the darker one can sit on top of it.

1.3 Designing for a purpose

- If the one-sentence job needs the word "and", the print is being asked to do two jobs and should probably become two prints.
- A passer-by who is walking needs one bold shape with plenty of space around it. A tag held in the hand can carry finer detail, because the viewer is close.
- A strong plan can say who looks at the print, and from how far away, before any block is cut.

1.4 Producing a final print

- An edition is the set of prints that matched, not every print that was pulled. Two rejects out of six pulls is ordinary and honest.
- A pale print is not fixed by pressing harder, because pressing harder squashes the block and spreads the shape. Re-ink thinly and press evenly instead.
- The back of every final print carries the name, the date and the job, in pencil, written after the print is dry.

Sources and references

The scheme of work in PDF/InpuT is scope only. Full source notes for teachers are kept in 05-SOURCES-01.md. This student book does not copy third-party prose or art.

For teachers

How this book is built

- Four units map 1:1 to the 2025-2026 school scheme of work.
- Feature grammar matches the Prime Books lower-primary Art line (Y1-Y3).
- Write-on boxes are intentional empty space; do not fill them before printing.

- Open making tasks have no printed answer key.

Cambridge Pathway note

Cambridge does not publish a standalone Primary Art examination syllabus comparable to core subjects. This book is written for Prime School's Cambridge Pathway context: age-appropriate craft skill, purpose, evaluation and materials language. It is an independent Prime School publication.

Assessments (fold into Studio show)

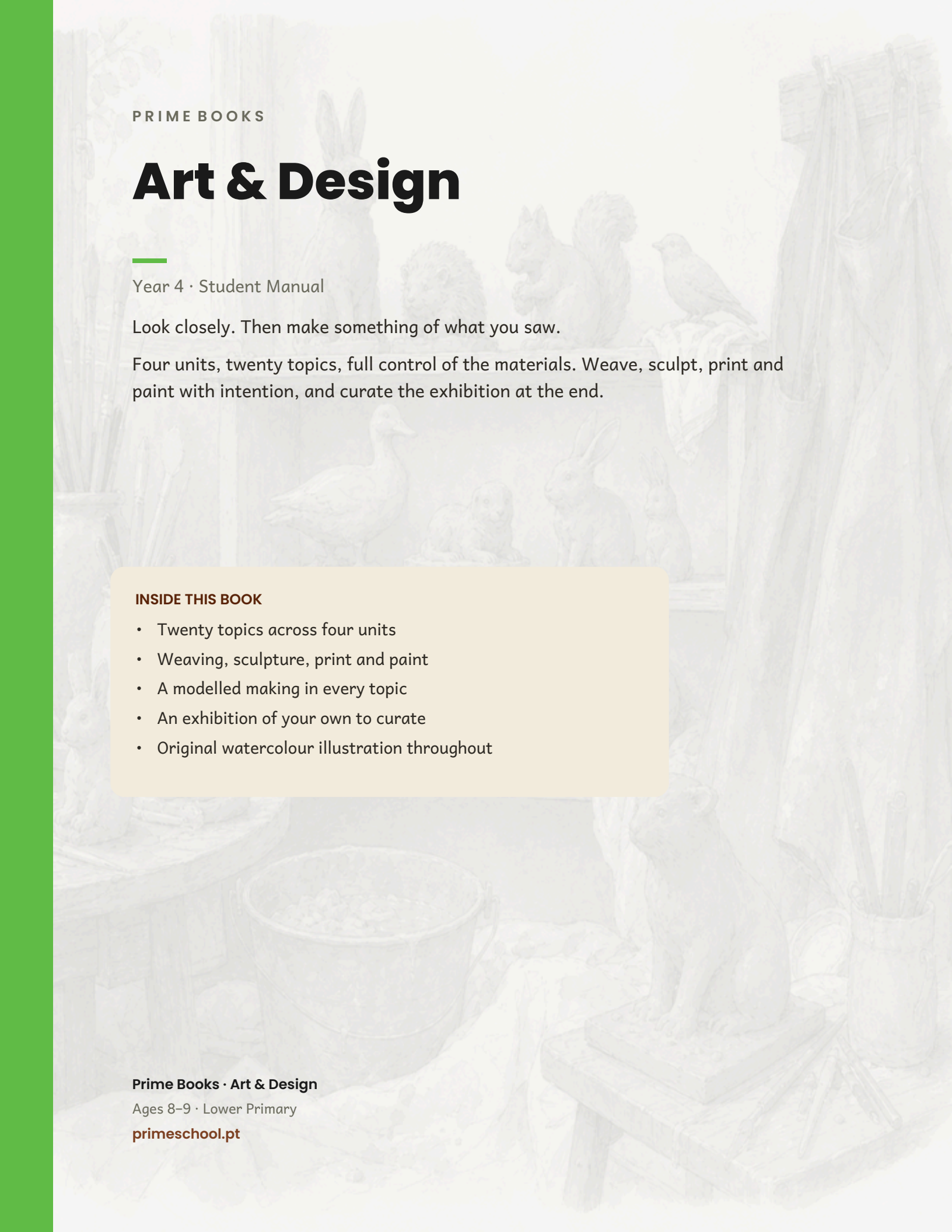
CHECKPOINT	EVIDENCE
Unit 1	final print with written purpose
Unit 2	observation painting + brush test strip
Unit 3	perspective drawing with dynamic figure
Unit 4	standing 3D model with label

School activities

- Print a class pattern for a shared display board.
- Paint a collaborative mural panel outdoors only with full safety plan.
- Architecture walk: photograph three forms, sketch one on return.
- Studio show for families: four tables (print, paint, line, build).

Materials planning

Order washable printing ink, foam sheets, card, corrugated card and air-dry clay in advance of Units 1 and 4. Unit 3 needs only dry media if paint is short.



PRIME BOOKS

Art & Design

Year 4 · Student Manual

Look closely. Then make something of what you saw.

Four units, twenty topics, full control of the materials. Weave, sculpt, print and paint with intention, and curate the exhibition at the end.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Twenty topics across four units
- Weaving, sculpture, print and paint
- A modelled making in every topic
- An exhibition of your own to curate
- Original watercolour illustration throughout

Prime Books · Art & Design

Ages 8–9 · Lower Primary

primeschool.pt